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OREGON CITY ENTERPRISE

The Enterprise is the only Clatsop County Newspaper that prints all of the news of this growing County.

FIFTY-THIRD YEAR—No. 49.

OREGON CITY, OREGON, FRIDAY, DECEMBER 26, 1919.

ESTABLISHED 1866

RAILROADS RETURN TO OWNERS ON MARCH 1ST

Washington, Dec. 25.—Control and operation of the nation's railroads, assumed by the government as a war measure two years ago, will revert to the owners on March 1, unless Congress passes a law to the contrary.

President Wilson issued a proclamation last March 1 as the time of the handing back of the roads.

The president in an address to Congress last May said he intended to turn back the roads at the end of the present year.

By another proclamation, issued with that in regard to the railroads, the president ordered the dissolution on March 1 of the American Railway Express company, which was formed July 1, 1918, under government direction by consolidation of the Adams, American, Wells Fargo and Southern companies.

SHIPPING BOARD WILL GO THE LIMIT FOR COAST PORTS

San Francisco, Dec. 23.—The United States shipping board will "go the limit" in providing ships for the Pacific coast trade, according to the opinion expressed today by the directors of the chamber of commerce by Charles C. Moore of San Francisco, who headed the Pacific coast delegation which appeared before the board recently to ask for greater allocation of ships to the west coast.

"It was plain to Chairman Payne that the united cities of the Pacific coast had completely subordinated their local interests before the board," said Moore. "A splendid case was presented to the board and it was shown that American interests would suffer unless proper recognition were given to the Pacific coast in the matter of ships with which to handle the great trans-Pacific burden of commerce."

"Chairman Payne said he had never before listened to so impressive and convincing a presentation."

The pressing immensity of the problem was brought home to the board, Moore said.

Postmaster Makes Trip Over Route

Postmaster Cooke, at one time sheriff of Clatsop county, and who has braved many a snow storm and slush, accompanied Mrs. E. M. Wambach, rural mail carrier, of Logan country, on her journey over the rough and snow covered roads Thursday.

This is the first trip Mrs. Wambach has been able to make since December 9, the day the heavy snow storm commenced. Even on Thursday the ground was well covered, and the snow was about a foot deep. Postmaster Cooke provided himself with a shovel in case he needed it to dig the automobile out of the snow.

Just one time was it necessary to use the shovel. Most of the places were reached, and those places where the little woman who has faithfully performed her duties for about two years had not reached Thursday were where it was impossible for any machine to enter for there was no road broken owing to the depth of the snow.

Friday Mr. Cooke went to the Red land country to assist Mrs. Wambach in getting the mail to that place. The road was even in worse condition than that leading to the Logan country.

Other rural carriers starting on their trips on Thursday were Lloyd Allen, of Route 1; Charles Andrus, Route 5; George Stewart, Route 3; Hazen Berhard, Route 6. Several took their mail by way of horse back, and were able to reach most of the patrons.

SHERIFF MAKES PRE-CHRISTMAS RAID ON STILL IN OPERATION

Sheriff W. J. Wilson certainly spoiled somebody's Christmas Tuesday when he raided a still in full operation in the Witchita section of this county near Milwaukie. The sheriff received information that moonshiners were operating in that section and shortly after noon Tuesday he together with deputies Henry Hughes and H. E. Meads got into a car and went to the house.

Meads went to the back door while the sheriff went to the front of the house. Meads heard the men inside and could hear the juice trickling from the coil on the stove and could also smell the odor. He pushed open the door and walked in. The two men within looked up but said nothing.

Meads went over to the stove and said, "Well boys, this is where I take a lesson or two in the fine art." The men were then placed under arrest.

On reaching the court house, the men were taken before Justice L. V. Stipp where they pleaded guilty. Al Strop, one of the men, was fined \$100. This he failed to pay and is now serving out his sentence in jail, at the rate of \$2 per day.

The raid netted the officers a complete distilling outfit in good working order and some five gallons of fruit whiskey which is known as "first run," which when tested by the government standard showed 50 proof or 25 per cent alcohol.

School Census Is Computed

The school census for Oregon City has been completed and the returns were turned over to County Superintendent C. A. Jalavan on Monday.

The census shows 842 boys and 861 girls of school age in this city, or a total of 1703. These figures show a gain of 48 over last year. The census of a year ago showed 896 boys and 819 girls.

The present census will mean that the increase in per capita tax will give an increase of some \$500 or \$600 for the schools over last year.

LOCAL SERVICE MEN HAVE RETURNED FROM SERVICE IN NAVY

Herman M. Curry, Seaman, U. S. N. of the U. S. S. Turkey; W. G. Harvey, Coxswain, U. S. N. of the U. S. S. Rail whose homes are in Oregon City, Ore., have recently returned from the Orkney Islands, Scotland. They came back with our minnowweavers, 36 of them and 24 subchasers. A fleet of battered and service worn ships indeed.

During the war the United States assisted by Great Britain laid the "Northern Barrage"—a minefield to sink German subs—from Scotland to Norway, or a distance greater than from Boston to Philadelphia. 7000 mines, with 350 pounds of T. N. T. every 20 feet. A ship did not have to touch a mine to explode it. It took a thin submarine to get by that.

But these 36 sweepers and 24 chasers cleared the field; thanks to the loyal, patriotic and daring efforts of Seaman Curry and Coxswain Harvey and the other men and officers working with them, from Admiral Strauss down to the latest recruit. It took six months to do it, but each day saw every officer and man more eager to get on with that task.

This minefield, the largest in the world's history, was laid in the short period of five months, and swept clean after the war in six months.

Young Man Pays Fine to Come Home

Albert Helvey of this city was one of three young men who were taken into custody by Sheriff Wilson last September on a charge of having liquor unlawfully in his possession. The other two were Sidney Irish and E. Wilkerson. These two paid their fines and were released.

Albert, however, left the county and has not been back since. But now he desires to return home and in order to do so he has sent to Sheriff Wilson \$50 and costs. The sheriff says that Albert may now return in safety to his home.

LONG AIR TRIP PLANNED

The Hague, Dec. 22.—An airplane flight from Holland to the Dutch Indies with Lausanne as the first stopping place is being arranged by M. Fokker, the airplane inventor. It is said.

A Weltering Chaos

Democracy cannot live where minority rules by force, explains John Spargo in the current number of the American Legion Weekly. In his discussion of the Bolshevik situation in Russia and in this country, Mr. Spargo tells plain truths that should be read with profit by every citizen of this country, as well as by every member of the Legion.

Vladimir Ulanov, commonly known to the world as Nikolai Lenine, the premier of Russia today, as far back as 1903, held that it was hopeless to get the assent of the majority to consent to his program for an extensive social change in Russia, and that a few strong and daring men must be relied upon to seize power. This has been done by Lenine and his followers in Russia and while a literal translation of the word Bolshevism means "majority," it is, in fact nothing of the kind, so far as Russia is concerned.

During the regime of the provisional government in Russia, thirty-six million people of all classes went to the polls and elected delegates to a constitutional convention. A majority of those elected were socialists representing the great peasant or farmers' organizations. The Bolshevik element loudly professed their faith in the constitutional convention, but when that body met, after Kerensky was overthrown by Lenine and Trotsky, backed by a regiment or two of disgruntled soldiers, the Bolsheviks dispersed it at the point of the bayonet.

Mr. Spargo issues a timely warning against the aggressions of Bolshevism in the United States. Russia is today a weltering chaos because of Bolshevik rule. Those who urge this kind of rule for this country can be fought only with intelligence and their propaganda must be killed with counter-propaganda in defense of real democracy.

SHOPPERS ARE HELD AT BAY IN SEATTLE HOLDUP

Seattle, Wash., Dec. 23.—Two men were seriously wounded and more than 100 Christmas shoppers were held at bay here tonight, when a lone robber, believed to have been the man who, at Olympia, Wash., last night shot and killed E. H. Schultz, attempted to hold up a stationery store in the First-avenue business district.

After a short run, pursued by clerks and customers of the store, the robber made good his escape by mingling with a crowd on Second avenue, a block away.

Olympia, Wash., Dec. 23.—The commissioners of Thurston county today authorized a reward of \$500 for the capture of the man who about 6 o'clock last night robbed the J. C. Penney department store of \$1300 and shot and almost instantly killed T. H. Schultz, one of his pursuers.

Search for the murder was continued by posse under the direction of Sheriff John H. Gifford. The strong guard placed on the roads last night immediately after the shooting was strengthened today and maintained tonight, officers announced.

Local Bank is Helping Farmers

OREGON AGRICULTURAL COLLEGE, Corvallis, Dec. 20.—The Bank of Oregon City is one of the 50 banks in Oregon to order farm record books for distribution among the farmers. These books are published by the department of farm management extension and have just been sent to the banks.

With one of these record books a farmer can keep accurate and complete account of the year's business. County agricultural agents assist the farmers in starting the records and in balancing them at the end of the year and also give them any other help that may be necessary.

TROOPS LEAVE LITHUANIA.

Riga, Dec. 22.—The last elements of the forces of Colonel Axeloff Bernoldt evacuated Lithuania December 14.

Six Governors Who Urge That Railroads in New England States Be Given Financial Aid When Returned to Owners



Governors of all the New England states, who met at Boston on invitation of Governor Coolidge of Massachusetts to consider transportation and fuel problems, adopted resolutions urging that financial assistance be given the New England railroads by the Federal government after their return to private control and that the United States Shipping Board be requested "to allocate some of its large ships to New England owners, operators and managers of steamers."

This photograph, taken at the conference, shows from left to right sitting: Governor Holcomb of Connecticut, Governor Coolidge of Massachusetts, Governor Clement of Vermont. Standing: Governor Bartlett of New Hampshire, Governor Beekman of Rhode Island, Governor Miliken of Maine.

Wounded Twice While in "Battalion of Death"



Few women have had more thrilling experiences than Mrs. Agnes Menefee, a pretty young Russian woman who arrived recently in this country to join her husband, an American artillery officer, at her home in Covington, Ky. Her maiden name was Agnes Rostkova. While serving with the famous "Battalion of Death" she was wounded twice in action and was decorated by the czar. She was a prisoner in Germany for six months but escaped. She met the officer who became her husband while she was doing war duty abroad.

DAYLIGHT ROBBERY IS ACT OF WOMAN, WHO MAKES ESCAPE

About 12:30 Monday Sheriff Wilson received a phone call from Mrs. W. H. Hart at Jennings Lodge that a woman had just been driven from her house as she was engaged in robbing the house. The sheriff went in answer to the call at once.

Mrs. Hart told him that she entered one of her bedrooms and saw a woman going through a trunk in the room. The woman ran out and out the back door. Mrs. Hart pursued her to the rear yard when the woman turned on her and said, "Now you have come far enough. You had better go back to the house."

For fear she might have a gun, Mrs. Hart returned to the house while the woman leaped over the back fence of chicken wire and made her way to the county road where she was picked up by an automobile which went on in the direction of Portland.

This is the second daylight robbery in the Jennings Lodge neighborhood in recent weeks. A short time ago the home of Mrs. Cushing was entered while she was absent from the house and in this case several hundred dollars worth of goods were stolen.

A license to marry was issued to Norman Garmire and Carrie Reddaway Monday in Oregon City.

GOV. OLCOTT RECOMMENDS FINLEY TO BE REINSTATED

Salem, Dec. 23.—Governor Olcott as chairman of the state fish and game commission, in a letter to the members of the commission today recommends that the action of December 11 in deposing Finley be rescinded, that Finley be reinstated as state biologist, and that he be "given a free and independent hearing in the management of the educational and biological department of the commission to the end that his knowledge as a naturalist may not be lost to the state."

The action of the governor today is based on the "widespread feeling that because of his ability as a naturalist and because of his value in advertising the state of Oregon, Finley should be retained in the state service."

Governor Olcott's letter, which is addressed to each member of the commission, expresses confidence in the sincerity of the action of the commission in dismissing Finley and in the integrity of the members of the commission.

"The action dispensing with Finley's service, in my opinion, was fully justified," the governor's letter reads. "I thought so then and think so now. While I had no knowledge that the matter was coming up at the particular time it did, some considerable time before I had given approval of the plan to allow Finley to retire from the service of the commission."

"Following the action of the commission and in response to a letter from Finley asking reconsideration I advised him that as far as I was concerned, as one member only, the incident was closed."

"If Finley could not bring himself to cooperate with it, the right and many thing, it seems to me, for him to have done would have been to separate himself from it by resigning rather than to remain."

"As to the purpose of the commission, I will say that during my ten months connection with same, I am convinced that the commissioners have all been sincere in their belief that their actions have been in the best interests of the propagation of game and fish. The members of this commission are, without exception, men of integrity who enjoy the respect of their neighbors and business associates."

"Finley is a naturalist of wide renown and along that particular line has a justly well deserved reputation. Apparently there is a widespread feeling that because of his ability as a naturalist and because of his value in advertising the state of Oregon, Finley should be retained in the state service."

"In view of the foregoing I believe the action of the commission should be rescinded and, if this is done, Finley should be given a free and independent hand in the management of the educational biological department of the commission to the end that his knowledge as a naturalist may not be lost to the state."

M'BAIN IS TO REPRESENT PAPER MILLS AT PORTLAND MEET

SALEM, Dec. 18.—Names of the five men who will represent the employers on the committee of 15 to confer in Portland December 22 on proposed legislation for the relief of injured workmen and their dependents under the workmen's compensation act were submitted to Governor Olcott this morning by the Industrial association of Oregon, as follows:

A. G. Labbe, vice president Willamette Iron & Steel company, representing metal trades; B. T. McBain, Crown Willamette Paper company, representing the paper industry; Geo. Gerlinger, Willamette Valley Lumber company, representing the lumber industry; Thomas Kay, Salem, of the Tom Kay Woolen mills, representing the woolen industry; D. A. Pattullo, Balfour, Guthrie company, representing the grain and flour industry.

REFUSES EXTRADITION.

Brussels, Dec. 22.—The Dutch government several weeks ago officially notified the allies it will not consent to the extradition of the former Kaiser to stand trial for war crimes, the Soier said today it had learned authoritatively.

Holland advanced several reasons for the stand, according to the news paper, including the "right of asylum."

STEAMER CATCHES FIRE.

Panama, Dec. 22.—The British steamer Crown of Galicia arrived yesterday with fire in her forward hold. She was docked by fire boats which extinguished the fire after five hours.

SUICIDE IS FOUND NEAR MT. HOOD CHRISTMAS

Sheriff W. J. Wilson received a call from Cherryville at 1:30 Christmas day from Mr. Friel, proprietor of the hotel at Cherryville telling him that there was a suicide out near Mount Hood and asked him to come out and investigate. Mr. Wilson, after getting in touch with Coroner Ed. Johnson left in his car for Cherryville. There he was directed to a cabin on the Mt. Hood road some thirty miles from Oregon City.

The sheriff on entering the cabin found a man lying on the floor in a weltering pool of blood. It was soon discovered that he had died from a gun shot wound through the heart. A further search disclosed a note saying: "Do not blame any one for this. I did it myself."

There was no motive given for the deed. The name signed to the note was Charles Peschell. Jack Greenwood, an employee of the Arawanna hotel missed Peschell early Christmas morning and went to his cabin to investigate.

He found him dead within. Greenwood at once telephoned to Cherryville and reported the death. Mr. Friel, the hotel man, then telephoned to Sheriff Wilson, who went at once in response to the call.

Up to midnight Thursday night the sheriff and coroner had not arrived in Oregon City, but the Enterprise was fortunate enough to reach Sheriff Wilson at Cherryville by phone about ten o'clock when he gave out the above details of the affair.

LEGION MEN ARE IN FAVOR OF LIVING MEMORIALS

Movement among South Dakota members of the American Legion for the erection of living memorials in the form of community centers rather than monuments in honor of those who served in the war against Germany is referred to in a news story printed in The Sentinel, published in Madison, South Dakota.

The Sentinel says:

"The agitation on the part of the American Legion of this state for buildings, no monuments, as memorials," which is being stimulated by the work of the bureau of memorial buildings of the War Camp Community service, finds approval of the national executive committee of the Legion in New York city. The state publicity bureau calls attention to a recent bulletin on this subject from the publicity department of the Legion as follows:

"The War Camp Community service has very kindly agreed to provide at the national convention in Minneapolis an exhibit on the memorial building project and will have one of their representatives in attendance who will be thoroughly familiar with the entire subject and who will be able to answer all questions and give full information. In view of the necessity of procuring suitable meeting places in which to gather, a number of posts throughout the country are endeavoring to secure a memorial hall, use of available patriotic funds and various other methods. It is probable that these halls will be more useful in expressing the gratitude of the people and will cost less in many instances than the multiplicity of monuments, fountains, etc. It is believed that the present is the time if anything is to be done toward securing memorial buildings for the reason that very likely as time goes on many of the citizens will become dormant in their interest in the returned veterans. If you desire to boost this idea along in your community do not fail to consult the War Camp Community service exhibit at Minneapolis."

PAY LINE OF 75 HELD UP

NEW YORK, Dec. 20.—A holdup rivaling in technique the masterpieces of "Bill" Carlisle, occurred here today when two robbers covered a pay line of 75 longshoremen while two companions, marching into the paymaster's office, seized \$500.

STRAYS RAIDING FARMS

YAKIMA, Wash., Dec. 20.—Reports brought by residents of the Yakima reservation are that stray ponies are a serious nuisance to farmers of that district. In their desperation at the inroads of the horses, the owners of invaded premises have resorted to arms and many of the horses have been badly wounded. Some have been killed.